

Writing & Documentation Portfolio

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Documents 1 to 6 are fictional samples written to show how I approach each kind of document; their organization names, systems, numbers, and dates are illustrative. The two iBOS samples are screenshots of work I produced and published. Links inside the documents open the online versions at kathleenmakaitaylor.github.io.

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Vendor Onboarding SOP

Standard Operating Procedure | Procurement & Finance

Document Owner: Procurement Department

Applies To: U.S. entities and UAE entities (differences are shown in the Required Documents table)

Effective Date: August 2026

Version: 1.1 (see Revision History)

Review Cycle: Annually, or when the process or policy changes

Portfolio sample. The organization, systems, timelines, and thresholds in this document are illustrative.

1. Purpose

This SOP defines the standard process for onboarding new vendors. It gives requesting departments a clear, step-by-step procedure and gives Finance and Procurement the checks they need to ensure that every vendor is compliant, accurate, and activated on time.

2. Scope

In scope: all new vendors requested by any department for goods, services, or recurring contracts, in both U.S. and UAE offices. Changes to an existing vendor's bank details are also covered (see Exceptions and Special Cases).

Out of scope: employee reimbursements, which follow the Expense Approval Workflow, and utilities or government bodies that Finance sets up directly.

3. Definitions

Term	Meaning
Vendor	An outside business or individual that provides goods or services to the company and is paid by it.
Vendor Request Form	The online form in the Procurement Portal used to request a new vendor and attach supporting documents.
IRS Form W-9	A U.S. form on which a vendor provides its legal name and taxpayer identification number. Non-U.S. vendors paid by a U.S. entity provide a W-8 series form instead.
1099 status	Whether payments to a U.S. vendor must be reported to tax authorities on an information return. Finance determines this during review.
Backup withholding	Tax withheld from payments when a vendor's taxpayer ID is missing or does not match records.
Tax registration certificate (TRN)	A UAE document confirming a vendor's registration for tax purposes.
Trade license	A UAE government license showing a business is legally allowed to operate.

Term	Meaning
ERP system	The enterprise system where vendor profiles are created and purchase orders are issued (for example SAP Ariba, Coupa, or NetSuite).
Purchase order (PO)	A document authorizing a purchase from an approved vendor.

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities	Must not
Requesting Department	Completes the Vendor Request Form, attaches all required documents, and answers questions from Finance.	Approve its own request or edit bank details after submission.
Manager or Director	Confirms the business need and approves the request before it goes to Finance.	Act as the Finance reviewer for the same request.
Finance	Reviews documents, runs the compliance checks, and approves the vendor or returns the request with a reason.	Create the vendor profile.
Procurement	Creates the vendor profile in the ERP system, confirms activation, and maintains this SOP.	Approve compliance checks.

Keeping these duties separate means no one person can request, approve, and pay a vendor. This is a basic fraud-prevention control.

5. Procedure

Step	Owner	Action	Target time
1	Requesting Department	Complete the Vendor Request Form in the Procurement Portal and attach all required documents (see Required Documents).	Same day
2	Manager or Director	Review the request for business need and approve it, or return it with comments.	1 business day
3	Finance	Review documents and complete the compliance checks (see Compliance Checks and Controls). Approve the vendor, or return the request with a clear reason.	2 business days
4	Procurement	Enter the vendor details in the ERP system and create the vendor profile.	1 business day
5	Procurement	Send an activation confirmation to the requesting department.	Same day
6	Requesting Department	Begin issuing purchase orders to the vendor.	After confirmation

Overall target: up to 5 business days from a complete submission to activation. The clock stops while a request is returned for corrections.

Vendor Onboarding Approval Flow

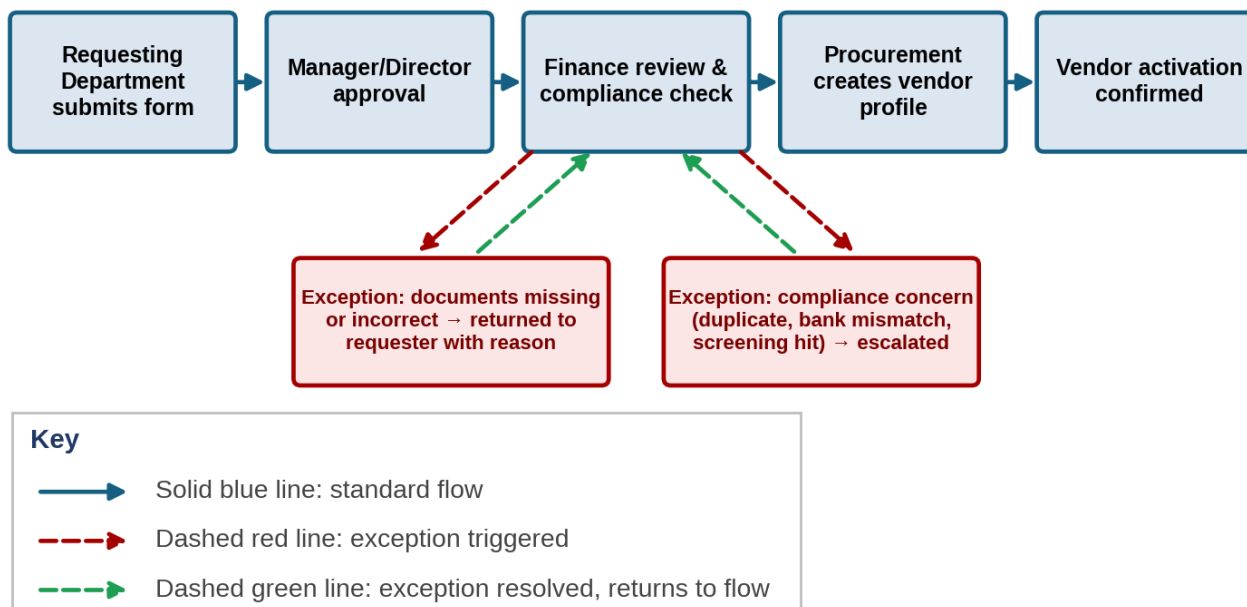


Figure 1. Vendor onboarding approval flow, including exception paths.

6. Required Documents

Document	U.S. entities	UAE entities
Tax identification	IRS Form W-9 (U.S. vendors) or W-8 series form (non-U.S. vendors)	Tax registration certificate (TRN), where the vendor is registered for tax
Business registration	Proof of business registration or incorporation	Trade license
Bank details	Signed bank details letter or voided check	Bank letter showing account name and IBAN
Contact and address	Primary contact name, email address, and mailing address	Primary contact name, email address, and mailing address
Contract or quote	If applicable	If applicable

The image shows a 'Vendor Request Form' from a 'Procurement Portal'. The form is divided into several sections with input fields and upload buttons. The sections are: Vendor Legal Name (Acme Supply Co.), Vendor Type (Recurring Services), Primary Contact Name (Jordan Lee), Contact Email (jordan@acmesupply.com), Mailing Address (500 Business Ave, Suite 200, Los Angeles, CA 90015), Tax ID / W-9 Upload (acme_w9.pdf), Bank Details Upload (acme_bank_details.pdf), and Notes for Finance Review (Recurring monthly service contract, first PO expected Sept 2026). At the bottom right, there are two buttons: 'Save Draft' and 'Submit Request'.

Figure 2. Vendor Request Form (fictional sample).

7. Compliance Checks and Controls

Check	What is verified	Owner
Duplicate vendor	Search the ERP system by legal name, tax ID, and bank account to confirm the vendor does not already exist.	Finance
Tax ID validation	The legal name on the form matches the W-9 or tax registration certificate. Finance also determines 1099 status and whether backup withholding applies.	Finance
Bank detail verification	Confirm the bank details by calling a known vendor contact number, not the number on the form, before the first payment.	Finance
Sanctions and watch list screening	Screen the vendor against the sanctions and watch lists required by company policy.	Finance
Conflict of interest	The requester confirms whether anyone at the company has a personal connection to the vendor.	Requesting Department

8. Exceptions and Special Cases

Situation	What to do
Documents are missing or incorrect	Finance returns the request with the reason. The requester corrects it and resubmits. The Finance target time restarts on resubmission.
Urgent request	Mark the request Urgent and state the business reason. The Manager or Director must approve the urgency. Finance prioritizes the review but does not skip any check.
One-time vendor	Set up as a one-time vendor with Finance approval. The same compliance checks apply, and the profile is deactivated after the payment.

Situation	What to do
Change to an existing vendor's bank details	Submit a Vendor Change Request, not a new form. Finance must verify the change by call-back before it is applied. Never accept bank detail changes by email alone.
Request rejected	The requester is told the reason. They may correct and resubmit, or escalate to the Procurement Manager.

9. Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely cause	Fix
The Submit Request button is inactive.	A required field or upload is missing.	Check each field and attachment, then try again.
The request was returned twice.	The vendor's legal name does not match the tax document.	Use the exact legal name from the tax document and re-upload.
The portal reports a duplicate vendor.	The vendor already has a profile.	Contact Procurement to reactivate or update the existing profile.
No activation after 5 business days.	The request may be waiting on a step.	Check the request status in the portal, then contact the Procurement Help Desk with the request number.

10. Records and Retention

The completed Vendor Request Form and all supporting documents are stored in the vendor profile in the ERP system. Records are kept for the period set by the company retention schedule and applicable tax law.

11. Related Documents

- [Expense Approval Workflow](#): for employee reimbursements, which are outside this SOP.
- Procurement Policy and Delegation of Authority matrix: company intranet.

12. Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
0.1	August 12, 2026	Kathleen (Katie) Taylor	Initial draft
0.2	August 13, 2026	Kathleen (Katie) Taylor	Incorporated Finance feedback on required documentation; added Manager or Director approval step
1.0	August 14, 2026	Kathleen (Katie) Taylor	Added mailing address field; finalized for release
1.1	October 7, 2026	Kathleen (Katie) Taylor	Added definitions, target times, U.S. and UAE document comparison, compliance controls, exceptions, troubleshooting, and records sections; updated the flow diagram with exception paths

Expense Approval Workflow

Process Documentation | Finance Operations

Document Owner: Finance Department

Applies To: U.S. entities and UAE entities (UAE equivalents are shown in brackets)

Effective Date: August 2026

Version: 1.1 (see Revision History)

Review Cycle: Annually, or when the expense policy changes

Portfolio sample. The organization, systems, limits, and timelines in this document are illustrative.

1. Overview

This workflow explains how employees submit business expense claims, how claims are reviewed and approved, and how reimbursement is processed, in line with the company expense policy. It also explains what to do when a receipt is missing, a claim is large, or a claim is returned.

2. Definitions

Term	Meaning
Expense claim	A request, submitted in the expense system, to be reimbursed for business costs the employee paid personally.
Pre-approval	Written approval obtained before an expense is incurred. It is required for international travel and for any single expense above the claim limit.
Itemized receipt	A receipt that lists the vendor, date, each item purchased, tax, total, and payment method. A card payment slip alone is not itemized.
Business purpose	A short statement of why the expense was needed for work, for example "Client lunch with ABC Co. to review renewal terms."
Expense system	The online tool used to submit and approve claims, for example Concur (supports U.S. and UAE entities) or Expensify (U.S. teams).

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities	Target time
Employee	Submits the claim with itemized receipts, a business purpose, and any pre-approval.	Within 5 business days of the expense date or trip return
Line Manager	Reviews the claim for accuracy and business relevance. Approves it or returns it with comments.	2 business days
Finance Team	Verifies receipts, checks policy compliance, flags discrepancies, and schedules reimbursement.	3 business days
Controller or Finance Manager	Approves claims over USD 1,000. [UAE: AED 3,700, Finance Director approval.]	2 business days

4. Process Steps

Step	Owner	Action	Target time
1	Employee	Submit the claim in the expense system with itemized receipts, a business purpose, and any pre-approval.	Within 5 business days
2	Line Manager	Review the claim for accuracy and business relevance. Approve it, or return it with comments.	2 business days
3	Finance Team	Verify receipts and policy compliance. Flag any discrepancies to the employee.	3 business days
4	Controller or Finance Manager	Only for claims over USD 1,000 [UAE: AED 3,700]: review and approve.	2 business days
5	Finance Team	Schedule reimbursement on the next bi-weekly payroll or accounts payable (AP) run.	Next scheduled run

Expense Approval Workflow

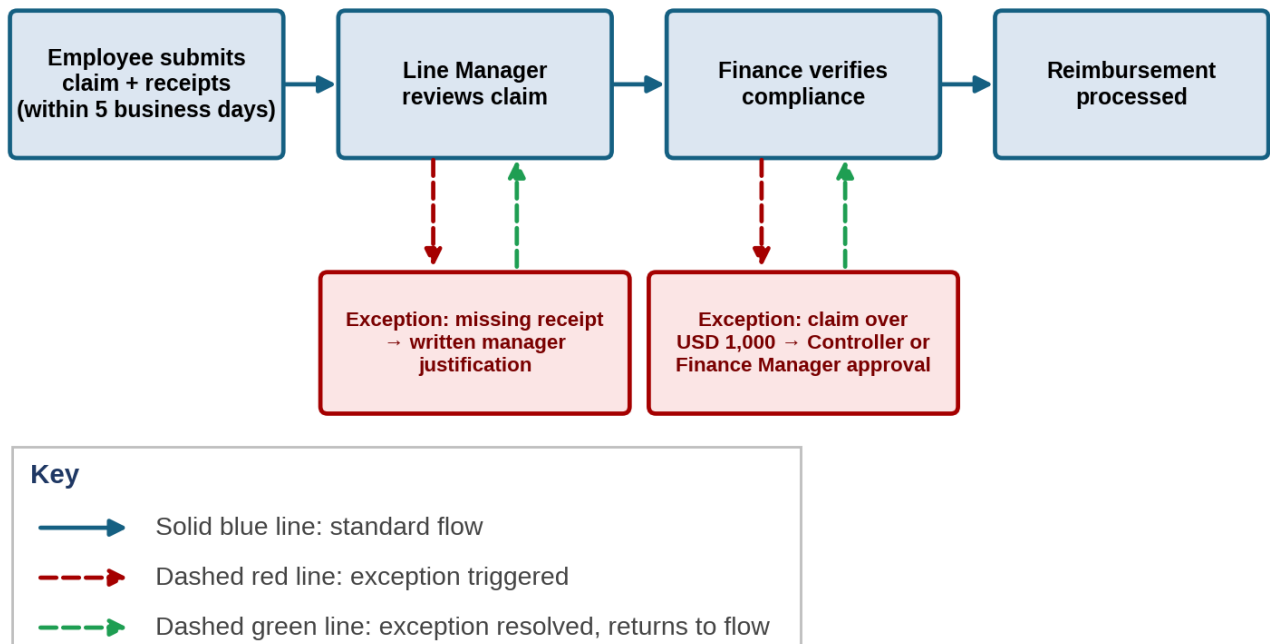


Figure 1. Expense approval workflow, including exception paths.

5. Exceptions and Special Cases

Situation	What to do
Missing receipt	Submit the claim with a written justification from the Line Manager and a short statement from the employee describing the purchase. Finance may still decline the item.

Situation	What to do
Claim over USD 1,000 [UAE: AED 3,700]	The claim also needs approval from the Controller or Finance Manager [UAE: Finance Director] after the Line Manager approves it.
Foreign currency expense	Enter the amount in the original currency. The system converts it using the rate on the transaction date. Attach the card or bank statement if the receipt does not show the rate.
Company card purchase	Submit the receipt in the expense system so the card statement can be reconciled. No reimbursement is paid.
Receipt mixes business and personal items	Claim only the business portion and note the split in the business purpose.
Submitted after the 5-day deadline	The Line Manager adds a short explanation. Late claims are still accepted but may be delayed or need additional verification.
Claim returned or rejected	The employee receives the reason, corrects the claim, and resubmits it within 5 business days of the return.

6. What Can and Cannot Be Reimbursed

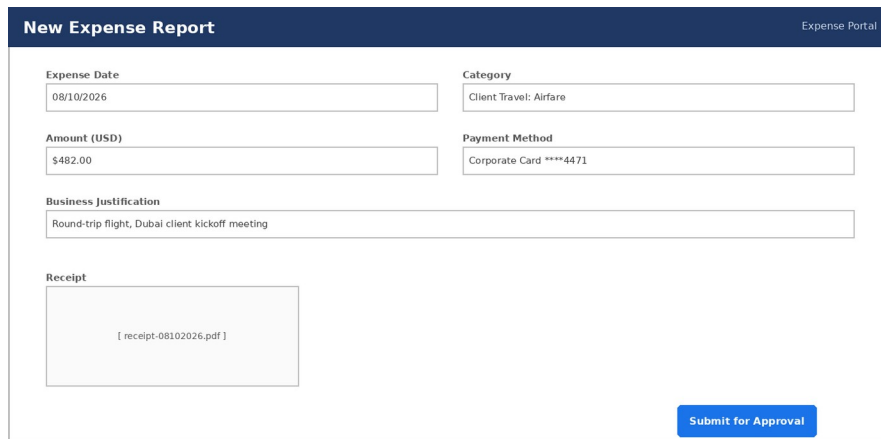
Category	Usually reimbursable	Not reimbursable
Travel	Economy airfare or rail, ground transport for business, hotel at the approved rate	Upgrades, personal side trips, fines and penalties
Meals	Business meals within the per-person limit, with attendee names and business purpose	Meals with no business purpose or attendee list
Other business costs	Pre-approved equipment, software, and supplies; client-facing costs with a business purpose	Items bought without pre-approval where it was required
Personal items	None	Personal entertainment, minibar charges, personal purchases

The per-person meal limit and approved hotel rates are set in the Travel & Expense Policy on the company intranet.

7. Completing the Claim

A complete claim is approved faster. Before you submit, check the following:

- Every expense line has its own itemized receipt attached.
- Each line has a business purpose written in plain words, not just a category.
- The pre-approval is attached, if one was required.
- The amounts and dates in the form match the receipts.



The image shows a web form titled "New Expense Report" with a dark blue header. The form is divided into several sections: "Expense Date" with a date picker set to 08/10/2026; "Category" with a dropdown menu showing "Client Travel: Airfare"; "Amount (USD)" with a text input set to \$482.00; "Payment Method" with a dropdown menu showing "Corporate Card ****4471"; "Business Justification" with a text area containing "Round-trip flight, Dubai client kickoff meeting"; and "Receipt" with a placeholder image labeled "[receipt-08102026.pdf]". A blue "Submit for Approval" button is located at the bottom right of the form.

Figure 2. Expense submission screen (fictional sample).

What an itemized receipt shows

A complete receipt shows the vendor name, date, each item with its price, tax, the total, and the payment method.



The image shows a sample itemized receipt from SkyLine Airways. The receipt is titled "SkyLine Airways" and "Passenger Receipt | Sample Data". It lists the following information: Passenger: A. Martinez; Confirmation #: SLY-482910; Route: JFK → DXB → JFK; Travel Date: 09/02/2026 - 09/06/2026; Fare: \$412.00; Taxes & Fees: \$70.00; Total Charged: \$482.00; Payment Method: Corporate Card ****4471.

Figure 3. Itemized receipt (fabricated sample for illustration only).

8. Common Reasons Claims Are Returned

Reason	How to avoid it
The receipt is a card slip, not itemized.	Ask the vendor for an itemized receipt at the time of purchase.
The business purpose is missing or vague.	Write who, what, and why, for example "Taxi to client site, ABC Co. meeting."
The expense was over the limit with no pre-approval.	Check the limit in the policy and request approval before spending.
The same expense was submitted twice.	Check the claim history, including company card entries, before submitting.
The claim was submitted late.	Submit within 5 business days, or ask your Line Manager to add an explanation.

9. Timeline

Claim type	Review and approval	Reimbursement
Standard claim	Up to 5 business days (Line Manager 2, Finance 3)	Next scheduled bi-weekly payroll or AP run
Claim over USD 1,000 [UAE: AED 3,700]	Up to 7 business days (adds 2 days for Controller or Finance Manager)	Next scheduled bi-weekly payroll or AP run

Reimbursement is typically received within 1 to 2 weeks of submission, assuming complete documentation and no exceptions.

10. Related Documents

- [Internal Travel Request FAQ](#): for travel approval before the trip.
- [Travel Cost Estimate Calculator](#): for estimating trip costs before requesting approval.
- Travel & Expense Policy: company intranet.

11. Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	August 14, 2026	Kathleen (Katie) Taylor	Initial release
1.1	October 7, 2026	Kathleen (Katie) Taylor	Added definitions, target times, submission deadline, special cases, reimbursable items table, claim checklist, and common return reasons; corrected the diagram to show the Controller approval path

Google Calendar Quick Start Guide

Quick Start Guide | Tools & Productivity

Audience: Executive assistants and administrative staff

Estimated Read Time: 8 minutes

Version: 1.1 (October 7, 2026)

Portfolio sample. The screenshots use a fictional calendar and fictional guests.

Introduction

This guide provides essential steps for scheduling and managing executive meetings using Google Calendar.

Key Features

- Create and edit events
- Add guests and check availability
- Manage recurring meetings
- Attach documents to events

Before You Begin

- You need a Google account with access to Google Calendar in a web browser. Menu names in this guide match the web version and may change over time.
- Check your own time zone in Settings > General > Time zone before you schedule anything.
- To manage an executive's calendar, you need their permission. Follow the steps in **Working With an Executive's Calendar** later in this guide.

Scheduling a Meeting

1. In Google Calendar, select "Create" and then "Event" from the drop down menu.
2. Enter the meeting title.
3. Enter the meeting location or meeting link for virtual attendees.
4. Select the timing for meeting notification reminders.
5. Enter the meeting description, agenda, and attach relevant documents (briefing notes, presentations, action trackers, etc.).
6. Add guests and review their availability using the "Find a time" feature.
7. For multi-region meetings, confirm each guest's displayed time zone before sending (e.g., ET/PT for U.S. attendees, GST for UAE attendees).
8. Click "Save" and "Send" invitations.

Create
Event

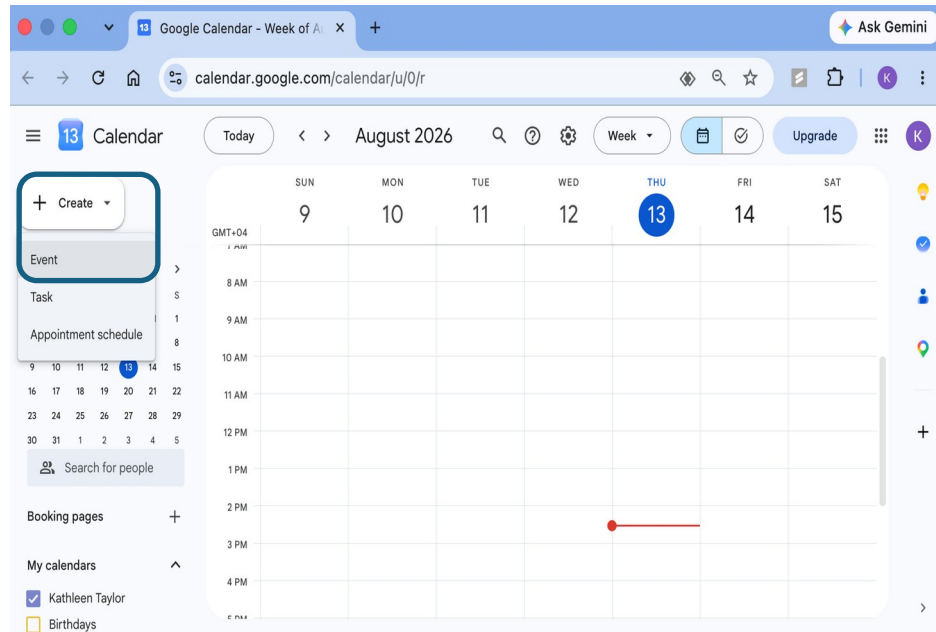


Figure 1. Google Calendar event creation panel

Title

Location

Reminders

Description,
Agenda, and
Attachments

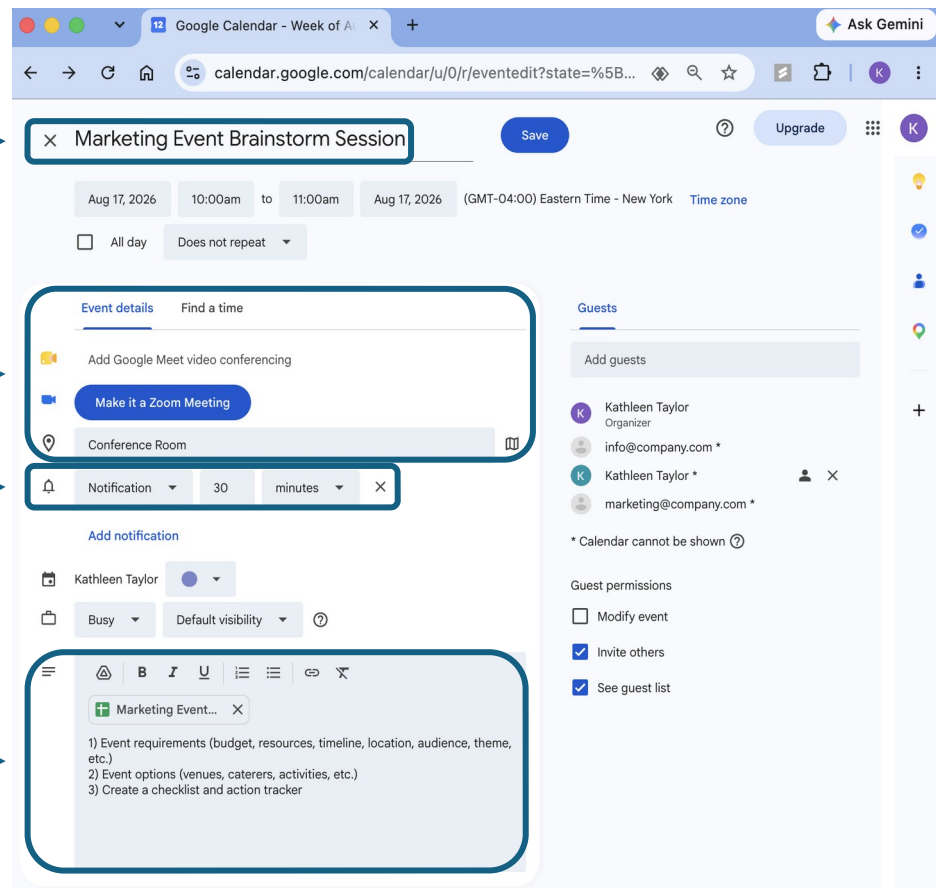


Figure 2. Event details panel

All guests are free at
10:00-11:00 AM
Eastern Time

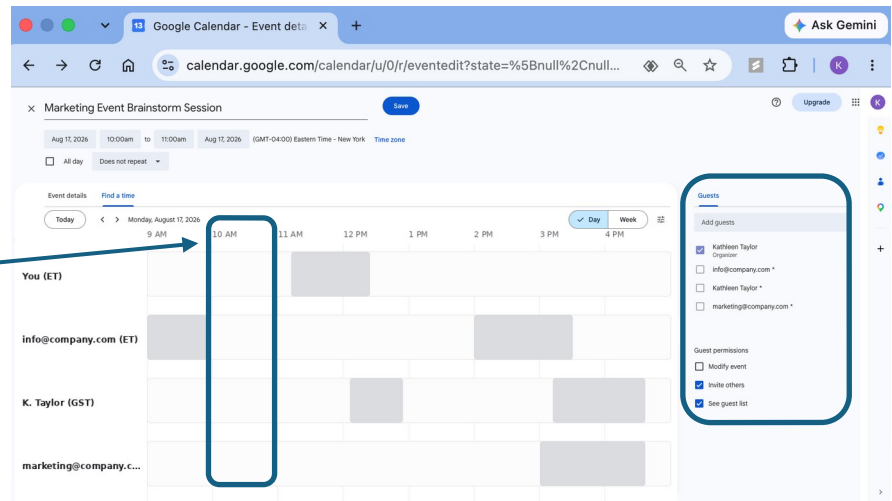


Figure 3. Add guests, and "Find a time" availability view across time

Save

Send

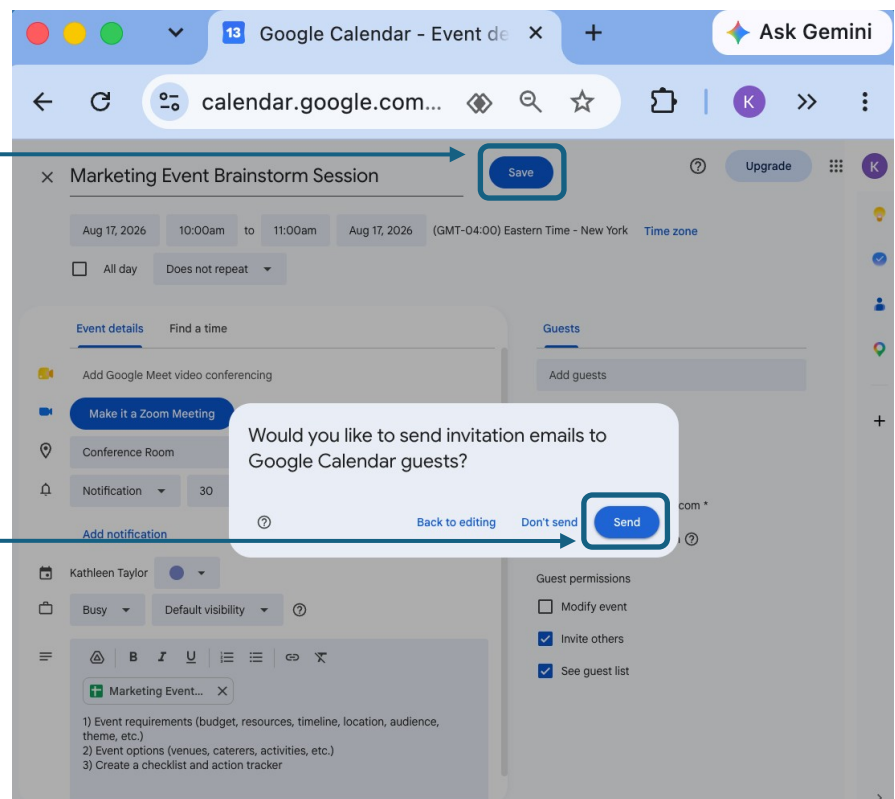


Figure 4. "Save" and "Send" event invitation

Managing Recurring Events

Select the recurrence option when creating an event to set a repeat pattern (daily, weekly, monthly, or custom). Use "This event" vs. "All events" carefully when editing a single occurrence of a recurring series to avoid unintentionally changing the whole series.

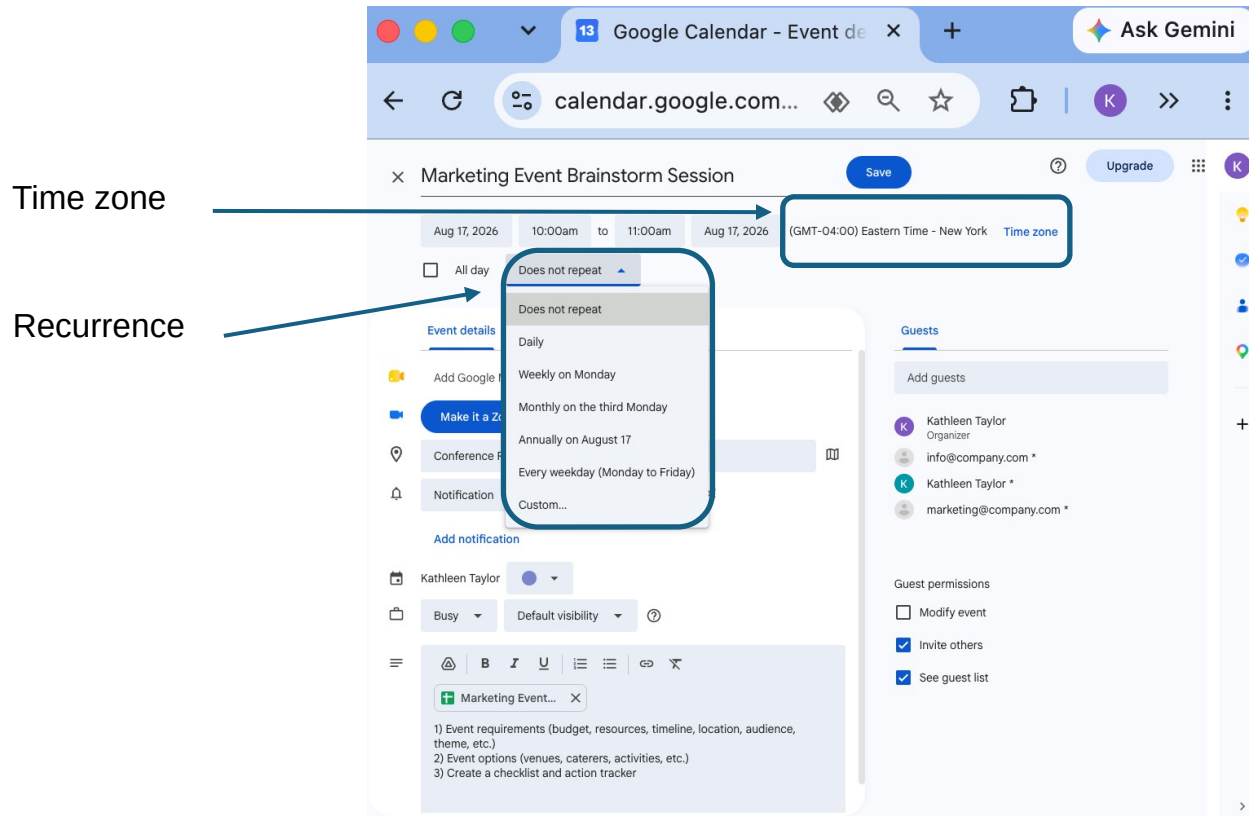


Figure 5. Recurrence settings and multi-time zone

Best Practices

- Use color coding for meeting categories.
- Add reminders for high-priority meetings.
- Include a clear agenda in the event description.
- For cross-time-zone scheduling (common for US/UAE coordination), always double-check the displayed time zone before sending.

Working With an Executive's Calendar

Before you can manage an executive's calendar, they must share it with you. The executive completes these steps:

1. Open Google Calendar and select Settings (the gear icon), then Settings.
2. Under Settings for my calendars, select their calendar.
3. Select Share with specific people or groups, then Add people and groups.
4. Enter your email address and set the permission to **Make changes to events**.
5. Select Send.

Accept the invitation if you are prompted. The executive's calendar then appears under Other calendars in your left sidebar, and you can create and edit events on it. If you can only view events, ask the executive to check the permission level.

Rescheduling and Cancelling

Rescheduling an event

1. Open the event and change the date or time, or drag the event to a new slot on the calendar.
2. Click Save.
3. When asked whether to send updates to guests, choose Send so everyone sees the new time.

Cancelling an event

1. Open the event and click the trash icon (Delete event).
2. Choose Send when asked whether to email cancellations to guests, so no one waits for a meeting that is not happening.
3. For a recurring series, choose **This event**, **This and following events**, or **All events** with care.

If you delete an event by mistake, click Undo right away, or restore it from Trash (events are kept for 30 days).

Working Across Time Zones

- Add a second time zone to your calendar view in Settings > General > Time zone, using Display secondary time zone.
- Set the executive's working hours in Settings > Working hours & location, so colleagues see when they are available.
- When creating an event, use the Time zone link beneath the date and time to set a different time zone for the start and end (see Figure 5).
- Before sending, open Find a time and confirm each guest's local time, especially for U.S. and UAE attendees.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely cause	What to do
Find a time shows no availability for a guest	The guest has not shared their calendar, or is outside your organization	Propose two or three times by email, or ask the guest to share free or busy information.
Guests see the wrong time	The event was created in the wrong time zone	Open the event, click the Time zone link, correct it, then Save and Send the update.
The whole recurring series changed	"All events" was selected when editing one occurrence	Click Undo immediately. Otherwise edit the series back to its original details.
A guest did not receive the invitation	Send was not selected, the address has a typo, or the message went to spam	Open the event, check the address, and use Email guests to resend.
You cannot edit the executive's event	You only have view permission	Ask the executive to change your permission to Make changes to events.

Keyboard Shortcuts

These shortcuts are specific to Google Calendar on the web and work the same on Windows and Mac. They are single keys, so no Ctrl or Command is needed. Turn them on in Settings > General > Keyboard shortcuts, then press the keys while the calendar page is open. Press ? to see the full list.

Key	Action
c	Create a new event
t	Go to today
d, w, m	Switch to day, week, or month view
j or n	Go to the next period
k or p	Go to the previous period
/	Search your calendar

Internal Travel Request FAQ

Knowledge Base Article | Employee Self-Service

Audience: All employees requesting business travel

Location: Company intranet > Travel & Expense

Owner: Finance Operations

Version: 1.1

Last Updated: October 7, 2026

Portfolio sample. The organization, intranet pages, approvers, and timelines in this article are illustrative.

Before You Travel

How do I submit a travel request?

Complete the Travel Request Form and submit it to your line manager for approval.

Where do I find the Travel Request Form?

On the company SharePoint site under Forms & Resources > Travel (see Figure 1). [UAE offices: company intranet > Forms & Resources > Travel.]

What does the form ask for?

Proposed travel dates, estimated costs (international and ground transportation, hotel, and visa fees if applicable), and the purpose of the trip or business justification.

What documents are required?

A valid passport copy, a proposed itinerary, and a cost estimate. For international travel, also attach the visa requirements for the destination country, if applicable.

How do I estimate my costs?

Use the [Travel Cost Estimate Calculator](#). Enter your trip details and attach the completed estimate to your request (see Figure 2).

Who approves my request?

Domestic travel is approved by your line manager. International travel is approved by the Department Head and the Controller or VP of Finance. [UAE equivalent: Department Head and Finance Director.]

How long does approval take?

Most requests are reviewed within 2 to 3 business days.

Can I book travel before my request is approved?

No. Book only after you receive written approval. Bookings made before approval may not be reimbursed.

What if I need to travel urgently?

Mark the request Urgent on the form and tell your line manager. Approval is still required, but approvers aim to respond within 1 business day.

Changes and Cancellations

What if my plans or costs change after approval?

Tell your line manager as soon as you know. If the destination or dates change, or the total cost rises more than 10% above the approved estimate, submit an updated request before you book the change.

What if I need to cancel?

Cancel bookings as soon as possible, tell your line manager, and keep every cancellation confirmation. You will need them to claim any non-refundable costs.

What if my request is rejected?

The approver will tell you the reason. You can revise and resubmit the request, or discuss alternatives with your line manager.

After Your Trip

How do I get reimbursed for my trip expenses?

Submit your actual costs through the standard expense process within 5 business days of returning. See the [Expense Approval Workflow](#) for the submission steps and the reimbursement timeline.

Which receipts do I need to keep?

Keep an itemized receipt for every expense, including airfare, hotel, ground transportation, and meals. A card payment slip alone is not enough.

Related Resources

- [Expense Approval Workflow](#): steps for submitting and approving expense claims.
- [Travel Cost Estimate Calculator](#): a working Excel file for estimating trip costs.
- Travel & Expense Policy and Preferred Travel Vendors List: company intranet.

Where to Find It

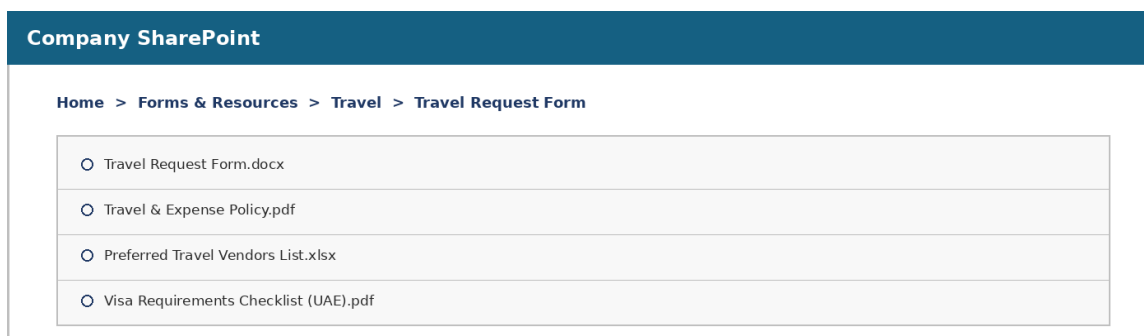


Figure 1. SharePoint navigation to the Travel Request Form (fictional sample).

Sample Cost Estimate

The Travel Cost Estimate Calculator is a working, formula-driven Excel file. The excerpt below shows its cost estimate table with sample figures.

Cost Estimate				
Category	Details / Notes	Rate	Qty / Nights	Estimated Cost (USD)
International Airfare	Round-trip, coach class			\$1,000
Ground Transportation	Airport transfers, taxi/rideshare, rental car			\$100
Hotel	Nightly rate x nights (auto-calculated)	\$200	4	\$800
Visa Fees (if applicable)	Destination visa / entry permit			\$100
Meals / Per Diem	Daily per diem x nights	\$50	4	\$200
Other	Incidentals, connectivity, etc.			\$50
Total Estimated Cost				\$2,250

Figure 2. Cost estimate table (sample figures; see the Excel file for the working version).

Editing Sample: Before & After

Editing | Internal Communications, Web Copy, App Text, and Contract Language

Version: 1.1 (October 7, 2026)

Skills demonstrated: Clarity and tone editing, author queries, consistency checking, and scope judgment

Formats covered: Policy reminder, internal announcement, website copy, app error message, and contract clause

Portfolio sample. The passages below are fictional examples written to show editing technique. They are not taken from any employer or client.

How I Edit

Every passage gets the same checks, in this order. The first check matters most: an editor improves the writing without changing what the author said, so anything I cannot verify becomes a query, not an edit.

1. **Accuracy and facts.** Dates, numbers, names, and claims are checked for support. Missing or unclear facts become questions for the author. I do not add facts.
2. **Clarity and structure.** One idea per sentence, the main point first, and an order the reader can follow.
3. **Tone and audience.** The voice matches the brand and the reader, whether that is a formal policy, a friendly announcement, or a short message in an app.
4. **Consistency.** Terms, capitalization, number style, and punctuation match throughout. Decisions are recorded in a style sheet (see below).
5. **Scope.** I stay within the level of edit requested. Legal, technical, and brand-claim questions go to the right person instead of being settled by the editor.

Example 1: Policy Reminder (Internal Communication)

Original text	<i>"Employees should try to submit their expenses on time because if they don't then finance might not be able to process them and this could cause delays and confusion."</i>
Author queries	• The draft says "on time" without defining it. What is the submission deadline? • What is the consequence of a late claim: rejection, delay, or extra checks?
Author response (illustrative)	Five business days from the expense date. Late claims are still accepted but may be delayed or need extra verification.
Revised version	Employees must submit expenses within five business days of the expense date. Late submissions may be delayed or require additional verification from Finance.
Changes made	• Replaced "should try to" with "must", because the author confirmed it is a requirement. • Replaced "on time" with the confirmed deadline. • Removed the "because if they don't then... and this could" chain and stated the confirmed consequence directly. • Used "Finance" with a capital F, matching how the team is named elsewhere in the style sheet.

Example 2: Internal Announcement

Original text	<i>"Hi all!! just a reminder that starting next month basically everyone is going to need to start using the new system for time off requests instead of emailing your manager directly so please make sure you check it out before then because IT said the old process won't really be supported anymore!!"</i>
Author queries	• What is the exact start date? "Next month" becomes unclear when the message is forwarded or read later. • Is the email process switched off completely on that date?
Author response (illustrative)	September 1. Email requests will no longer be supported after that date.
Revised version	Starting September 1, submit all time-off requests through the new PTO system instead of emailing your manager. The email process will no longer be supported after that date. Please log in and review the new workflow before then.
Changes made	• Replaced "next month" with the confirmed date. • Cut filler ("just a reminder," "basically," "make sure you check it out") that added length without meaning. • Split one run-on sentence into three short, direct ones. • Replaced the hedge "won't really be supported" with a clear statement, and removed "IT said" so the message speaks for the company. • Removed the double exclamation marks for a calm, professional tone suited to a company-wide message.

Example 3: Website Copy

Original text	<i>"We are a leading provider of innovative, cutting-edge learning solutions that empower learners to unlock their full potential and achieve their goals through our world-class platform."</i>
Author queries	• "Leading" and "world-class" are claims readers may want evidence for. Can we support them with rankings, awards, or customer numbers, or should we describe what the platform does? • What does the platform include? Please list the main features.
Author response (illustrative)	Short courses, practice quizzes, and progress tracking. Learners study at their own pace.
Revised version	Build new skills at your own pace. Our platform brings short courses, practice quizzes, and progress tracking together in one place.
Changes made	• Replaced unsupported superlatives with the concrete features the author confirmed. • Led with the reader's benefit instead of the company's self-description. • Removed stacked buzzwords ("innovative," "cutting-edge," "unlock their full potential") that say little. • Kept the brand's friendly, direct voice and used "your" to speak to the reader.

Example 4: App Text (Error Message)

Original text	<i>"Oops! Something went wrong!! Please try again later or contact support if the problem persists."</i>
Author queries	- Does the system know what failed (saving, loading, or connecting)? A specific message helps the user act. - Can users reach support from this screen? If so, how?
Author response (illustrative)	It is a save error, usually caused by a lost connection. Support is reachable from the Help menu.
Revised version	We couldn't save your changes. Check your internet connection and try again. If this keeps happening, contact Support from the Help menu.
Changes made	- Removed "Oops!" and the double exclamation marks, which sound casual at the moment a user is frustrated. - Named the problem and gave a next step, so the user knows what to do. - Capitalized "Support" as the team name, per the style sheet. - Kept it to three short sentences that fit a small message box.

Example 5: Contract Language

Scope: I edit contract text for clarity, consistency, and internal references only. What the clause legally means or allows is for the author or counsel to decide, so substantive questions are queried and not settled by the editor.

Original text	<i>"The Customer shall pay all invoices within 30 days and if the Customer doesn't pay on time the Supplier may charge interest on late amounts and may also suspend the services until payment is made."</i>
Author queries	- Does the 30 days run from the invoice date or the date the invoice is received? - Where is the interest rate set? Should the clause point to it? - Is notice required before services are suspended? "Services" is a defined term elsewhere in the contract. Should it be capitalized here?
Author response (illustrative)	From the invoice date. Interest is in clause 9.2. Five days' written notice is required before suspension. Yes, capitalize "Services."
Revised version	The Customer must pay each invoice within 30 days of the invoice date. If payment is late, the Supplier may charge interest on the overdue amount as set out in clause 9.2. After giving five days' written notice, the Supplier may suspend the Services until payment is received.

Changes made	• Split one long sentence into three, so each obligation stands alone. • Replaced "shall" with "must" to match the plain-language style sheet for this document. • Replaced "doesn't pay on time" with "payment is late" and removed the contraction. • Added the confirmed start date for the 30 days, the cross-reference to clause 9.2, and the notice period, all supplied by the author. • Capitalized "Services" to match the defined term.
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Sample Style Sheet

A style sheet records each consistency decision so the same choice is made every time, across documents and across editors. This is an excerpt from the sheet used for the examples above.

Item	Decision	Reason
Numbers	Spell out one to nine, use numerals for 10 and above and for amounts of money	Common house rule; keeps text readable and consistent
Dates	Month and day, no ordinal (September 1)	Shorter and clear to a global audience
Team names	Capitalize (Finance, Support)	Treats team names as proper nouns
email	One word, no hyphen	Current standard usage
Defined terms	Capitalize exactly as defined in the contract (Customer, Supplier, Services)	Keeps legal meaning consistent
Contractions	Avoid in policies and contracts; allowed in friendly web and app text	Matches formality of each format
Exclamation marks	Avoid in announcements and error messages	Calm, professional tone

What I Leave Alone

Good editing is also restraint. In the examples above, I deliberately did not change:

- The author's meaning, or any fact I could not verify. These became queries.
- Brand voice and product terms, such as "PTO system" and "Support," that the audience already knows.
- Legal substance in the contract clause. Only clarity, consistency, and references were edited.
- Intentional repetition or emphasis that serves the reader.

Data Privacy & Confidentiality Training

Facilitator Guide

Audience: Staff, volunteers, interns, and contractors who handle personal data about students, participants, customers, or colleagues, in any organization

Duration: 45 minutes

Format: Facilitated group session, in person or virtual (8 to 25 participants, working in small groups of 3 to 5)

Facilitator preparation: About 30 minutes (complete the customization box, confirm the privacy contact, print materials, review the scenario answer key)

At a glance: A complete facilitator guide for a 45-minute data privacy and confidentiality session, built to work in schools, education companies, and corporate learning teams.

- **What is inside:** timed session plan with scripts, a customization table, five core habits, a three-question sharing decision test, six scenario cards with answer key, a seven-question knowledge check, an evaluation plan, participant and facilitator FAQs, and a one-page handout.
- **Skills shown:** instructional design, plain-language writing, assessment design, and adaptable training materials.

Design notes: Why the session is built this way.

- **Learners:** staff, volunteers, interns, and contractors in any setting, including people new to the organization, who handle other people's information as part of their roles and are not privacy specialists.
- **Problem:** privacy training often boils down to "never share," which people quickly learn to ignore because sharing is a normal part of work. Many people also simply do not know what is okay to share and what is not.
- **Approach:** teach one decision test (need, minimum, channel) instead of a long rule list, so learners can handle situations the training never mentioned.
- **Practice:** scenarios deliberately include cases where sharing is correct and cases where it is not, so learners practice both saying yes and saying no.
- **Adaptability:** a customization table at the front lets any organization insert its own contacts, channels, retention rules, and success criteria, and each section points back to it.
- **Assessment:** every learning objective is checked by at least one knowledge check question and one scenario activity prompt (see the alignment table in Evaluating the Session).

Learning Objectives

By the end of this session, participants will be able to:

1. Explain why data privacy matters in their work
2. Identify what counts as personal or sensitive information
3. Apply their organization's data handling procedures, including deciding when sharing information is appropriate
4. Recognize and report a potential data privacy incident

Before You Facilitate: Customize This Guide

This session teaches good practice that applies in most organizations. Before delivering it, fill in the table below so participants hear their own organization's rules, not generic ones. Confirm the privacy contact before the session. Do not assume or assign this person yourself: ask HR, your manager, or the IT or compliance team who is officially responsible, and write down their name and contact details. Each row shows an example from three different settings: 1. a school, 2. a corporate learning and development (L&D) team, and 3. an education company.

Customization Table: Your Organization's Details

Item to complete	Your organization's answer	Examples: 1. School, 2. Corporate L&D, 3. Education company
Types of personal data handled		1. School: Student names, grades, medical notes. 2. Corporate L&D: Learner names, manager emails, assessment scores. 3. Education company: Account emails, birthdates, payment status.
Approved places to store and share data		1. School: School information system or secure school drive, not personal email. 2. Corporate L&D: Company learning management system or shared drive, not personal messaging apps. 3. Education company: Secure support ticketing tool or CRM, not personal cloud storage.
Examples of legitimate need-to-know		1. School: A teacher needs a student's emergency contact for a field trip. 2. Corporate L&D: A trainer needs a learner's manager email to send a completion reminder. 3. Education company: A support agent needs a student's account email to fix a login problem.
Privacy contact: who is officially responsible for privacy and incidents, and how and how soon to report an incident to them		1. School: Data protection lead or principal's office, the same day. 2. Corporate L&D: IT security or privacy officer through the incident form, within 24 hours. 3. Education company: Security team through the urgent ticket queue, immediately.

Item to complete	Your organization's answer	Examples: 1. School, 2. Corporate L&D, 3. Education company
Retention and disposal rule		1. School: Shred sign-in sheets once attendance is recorded; keep records per the school retention schedule. 2. Corporate L&D: If you are an outside trainer, the client usually owns the learner data, so follow the client's contract or data agreement and return or delete the data when the engagement ends. 3. Education company: Follow the company retention policy, which sets how long each type of record is needed, often with shorter periods for student records, especially minors.
Relevant law or policy (optional)		1. School: The school's student data protection policy and applicable education privacy law. 2. Corporate L&D: The client's data protection policy and the privacy law where the learners work. 3. Education company: The company privacy policy, privacy law in each country where students live, and any extra rules for children's data.
Success criteria and certificate (if any)		1. School: Attendance is recorded on the staff training log; no quiz score is required. 2. Corporate L&D: Completion is tracked in the learning management system and requires passing the knowledge check at the set score. 3. Education company: A certificate is issued after attending the full session and passing the knowledge check; retakes are allowed.

Note: This is general training, not legal advice. Laws and policies differ by country and organization. When this guide and your organization's own policy differ, the organization's policy applies.

Session Outline

Time	Topic	Method	Objective
0:00–0:05	Welcome And Session Objectives	Brief introduction	All
0:05–0:15	Why Data Privacy Matters	Facilitated discussion	1, 2
0:15–0:30	Data Handling Procedures	Walkthrough with example scenarios	2, 3, 4
0:30–0:40	Practice: Spot The Risk	Small group activity	2, 3, 4
0:40–0:45	Knowledge Check And Wrap-Up	Individual quiz and Q&A	1, 2, 3, 4

Section 1: Welcome And Session Objectives (0:00–0:05)

Purpose: Set a calm, practical tone and agree on ground rules before any examples are shared.

Steps

1. Greet participants and state the purpose in one sentence (1 minute).
2. Show the four learning objectives and read them aloud (1 minute).
3. Agree on ground rules (2 minutes). Ask participants to use fictional or anonymous examples only and not to name real people or describe real cases during the session. Remind them that questions are welcome.
4. Explain the format: short discussions, a worked example, a small group activity, and a brief quiz that is for learning unless your organization sets a passing score (1 minute).

Say: "Today is about handling other people's information with care while still getting our work done. Sharing information is a normal part of every job. We will practice telling the difference between sharing that helps and sharing that harms."

Section 2: Why Data Privacy Matters (0:05–0:15)

Purpose: Help participants connect privacy to real people and to their own daily work (Objectives 1 and 2).

Steps

1. **Opening question (3 minutes).** Ask: "What information do we collect from the people we work with, and what would happen if it ended up in the wrong hands?" Take answers from two or three participants before moving on.
2. **Key points (4 minutes).** Cover the points below in plain language, avoiding legal or technical jargon.
3. **Small group check-in (3 minutes).** Ask each small group to name one piece of personal data they handle in their role and who else in the organization might ask for it.

Key points to cover

- **Personal data** is any information that could identify a specific person, such as name, contact details, photos, ID numbers, grades or performance records, or location.
- **Sensitive data** (health status, disability or accommodation needs, protection or safeguarding cases, biometric data, financial details) needs extra care and should only be shared on a need-to-know basis.
- A privacy breach can put real people at risk, including harm to their safety, finances, or reputation, not just create paperwork for the organization.
- Good privacy practice is not about refusing to share. It is about sharing the right information, with the right people, for the right reason.

Sample responses to the opening question

What we collect: names, phone numbers and emails, home addresses, ID or account numbers, photos, grades or assessment results, attendance, health or accommodation needs, payment details.

What could happen: identity theft or fraud, unwanted contact or safety risks, embarrassment or discrimination, loss of trust in the organization, and legal or financial penalties for the organization.

Short case you can use: A tutoring program emails a sign-up list with home addresses to the wrong parent by mistake. Two families receive unwanted contact, and one stops attending. Ask: Who was affected, and how? The harm falls on the families first, not on the program.

Facilitator tip: If a participant says "we have never had a problem," ask what the organization would do tomorrow if a spreadsheet went to the wrong person. This leads naturally into Section 3.

Customize: Name the types of personal data your organization actually handles, from the customization table, when you take participants' answers.

Section 3: Data Handling Procedures (0:15–0:30)

Purpose: Give participants five practical habits, a simple test for deciding when to share, and clear steps for reporting an incident (Objectives 3 and 4).

Part A: Five core habits (6 minutes)

Habit	What it looks like	Example
1. Collect only what you need	Before asking for a piece of information, ask whether the task truly requires it.	A workshop sign-in sheet needs a name and email, not a date of birth.
2. Share on a need-to-know basis	Share when someone needs the information to do their job, and share only the part they need.	A trainer needs a learner's email to send a reminder, but not that learner's assessment history.
3. Use approved channels	Store and send personal data only through systems your organization approves.	Use the shared drive or secure ticketing tool, not a personal messaging app.
4. Protect it where it lives	Lock screens, use strong passwords, keep paper out of sight, and keep files in approved locations.	Do not leave a printed learner list on a shared printer or desk.
5. Keep it only as long as needed	Follow your organization's retention rule and dispose of data securely.	Shred printed sign-in sheets once attendance is recorded.

Customize: State your organization's approved places to store and share data and its retention rule from the customization table, so participants hear their own rules.

Part B: The sharing decision test (5 minutes)

Introduce three questions to ask whenever someone requests personal information. Write them on a slide or flip chart:

- Need:** Does this person need the information to do their role?
- Minimum:** Am I sharing only what they need, and nothing more?
- Channel:** Am I using an approved way to share it?

Walk through the three worked examples below, asking participants to apply the test before you reveal the decision.

Request	Need?	Minimum?	Channel?	Decision
A teacher asks the school office for a student's emergency contact before a field trip.	Yes, supervising the trip.	Only that student's emergency contact.	School information system or a trip list returned afterward.	Appropriate to share.
A trainer asks HR for a learner's manager email to send a completion reminder.	Yes, sending the reminder.	Email address only, not other HR data.	HR system or approved email.	Appropriate to share.
A colleague who is curious asks to read a participant's accommodation notes.	No job-related reason.	Not applicable.	Not applicable.	Decline politely. Point them to whoever owns the record if they have a work reason.

Say: "The answer is rarely a flat yes or no. A teacher, a trainer, or a manager often does need personal information. We just check need, minimum, and channel every time."

Part C: When something goes wrong (4 minutes)

What counts as a potential incident: information sent to the wrong person, a lost or stolen device or paper file, someone accessing records without permission, personal data posted somewhere public, or a reply to a suspicious message that asked for personal data.

Teach the four steps:

1. **Stop.** Do not forward, delete, or try to fix it quietly. Keep any evidence, such as the email.
2. **Report immediately** to the privacy contact named in the customization table, even if you are not sure it is serious.
3. **Share the facts:** what happened, when, whose information, and who may have received it.
4. **Follow instructions.** The focus is on protecting people, not blaming individuals. Do not investigate on your own.

Facilitator tip: Stress that reporting early is the single most helpful thing a person can do. Many incidents become serious because they were hidden, not because they happened.

Section 4: Practice: Spot The Risk (0:30–0:40)

Purpose: Let participants apply the habits, the sharing test, and the reporting steps to realistic situations (Objectives 2, 3, and 4).

Materials: one set of the six scenario cards below per group, printed and cut apart, and the facilitator answer key.

Steps

1. **Set up (1 minute).** Form groups of 3 to 5 and give each group a set of cards. Assign two or three cards per group (all six if time allows).

2. **Discuss (5 minutes).** For each card, the group answers: Is there a risk? Who could be harmed, and how? Which habit or test applies? What should the person do next? Ask groups to jot down one sentence per card.
3. **Debrief (4 minutes).** Invite one group per card to share its answer, then reveal the key. Highlight that Card 4 is a case where sharing is appropriate, so participants practice both saying yes and saying no.

Customize: Replace or add scenarios that match your organization's settings and data types. Keep at least one case where sharing is appropriate, one where it is not, and one incident.

Scenario cards (print and cut apart)

Card	Setting	Situation
1	School front office	A parent calls and asks for the home phone number of another family so the two can arrange a carpool.
2	Corporate learning and development	A trainer exports a learner results spreadsheet that includes names, manager emails, and accommodation notes, and sends it from a personal email account to an outside vendor who is building a report.
3	Education company support team	A support agent pastes a screenshot of a student's account page, showing full name, email, and birthdate, into a team chat channel with 200 members to ask a quick question.
4	School trip planning	A teacher leading a field trip asks the school office for the information needed to look after the 24 students on the trip: emergency contacts, dietary restrictions, allergies, health concerns, and disability or accommodation needs. The teacher does not ask for grades or other records.
5	Remote working	A staff member working from a cafe steps away to order a coffee, leaving a laptop open to a screen of learner records.
6	Any workplace	A teammate mentions that last week they emailed an attendance spreadsheet to the wrong person with the same first name, then deleted the sent message and hoped it was fine.

Facilitator answer key

Card	Risk or issue	Strong response
1	Sharing a third party's contact details without their consent. The parent has no work-related need.	Do not share. Offer to pass the parent's number to the other family, or invite the other family to make contact if they wish.
2	Unnecessary sensitive data (accommodation notes) and an unapproved channel (personal email).	Remove the accommodation notes and any other unneeded fields, and send the file through the approved vendor channel under the organization's data sharing arrangements.
3	Over-broad audience and more detail than needed.	Delete the post if possible and report it if it is a breach. In future, mask personal details and ask the specialist directly or through the ticketing tool.

Card	Risk or issue	Strong response
4	Appropriate. The teacher has a clear need, because trip safety depends on knowing each student's emergency contact and any dietary, allergy, health, or accommodation needs. The request is limited to the 24 students and to trip-relevant information. Although this is sensitive data, need-to-know applies.	Share a trip-specific learner profile for those 24 students only: emergency contacts plus relevant dietary, allergy, health, and accommodation information. Leave out grades, behavior records, and anything unrelated to the trip. Use the school system or a trip list kept by the teacher, then return or destroy it after the trip.
5	Screen exposure of personal data in a public place.	Lock the screen whenever stepping away, use a privacy screen, and work from a private space when handling learner records.
6	An unreported incident. Deleting the sent message does not undo the exposure.	Report to the privacy contact now, with the facts. Support the teammate without blame. Early reporting still helps even a week later.

Section 5: Knowledge Check And Wrap-Up (0:40–0:45)

Purpose: Confirm understanding of all four objectives and invite a personal commitment.

Steps

1. **Quiz (3 minutes).** Participants answer the seven questions individually on the handout or on screen. Review answers aloud and ask for a show of hands on each; the quiz is for learning unless your organization sets a passing score.
2. **Wrap-up (2 minutes).** Ask each participant to write down one habit they will use this week, then invite two or three volunteers to share. Point to the quick reference handout and the privacy contact.

Sample commitments if participants are stuck: Prompt with "What will you do, and when?" and offer examples. Make vague answers like "be more careful" specific.

- Lock my screen every time I step away.
- Send only the columns a person needs.
- Use the approved channel instead of my personal messaging app.
- Mask names and birthdates in screenshots.
- Delete old copies of exported lists.
- Save the privacy contact's details in my phone.
- Report a mistake the same day.

Customize: Before the quiz begins, tell participants how success is determined (for example, attendance only, finishing the activity, or passing the knowledge check), using the success criteria row of the customization table.

If you are running short on time: Complete questions 1 to 6 in the session and assign question 7 as a follow-up reflection.

Knowledge check questions and answer key

Question 1 (Objective 2). Which of the following is considered sensitive personal data?

- (a) A participant's first name
- (b) A participant's health status
- (c) The program location
- (d) A company's public office address

Answer: (b). *Health information can cause serious harm if exposed, so it needs extra care and need-to-know sharing.*

Question 2 (Objective 3). A colleague from another team asks you for a participant's phone number. What is the best response?

- (a) Share it, since you work for the same organization.
- (b) Decline, because contact details can never be shared.
- (c) Ask what they need it for, and share it only if it is needed for their work and your organization's procedures allow it.
- (d) Share it, as long as they promise not to pass it on.

Answer: (c). *Sharing is often appropriate when it is job-related. The test is need-to-know and an approved purpose, not whether the person is a colleague or senior.*

Question 3 (Objective 3). Which is an approved way to share a participant list with a teammate who needs it for their work?

- (a) A personal messaging app
- (b) A shared folder your organization approves, with access limited to the team
- (c) A printout left on a shared desk
- (d) Your personal email account

Answer: (b). *Approved channels with limited access protect the data and give the organization control over it.*

Question 4 (Objective 1). True or false: A privacy breach mainly creates extra paperwork for the organization.

Answer: False. *A breach can put people at real risk, such as fraud, unwanted contact, discrimination, or harm to their safety, and it damages trust.*

Question 5 (Objective 4). You realize you sent a spreadsheet of participant details to the wrong recipient. What should you do first?

- (a) Wait to see whether anyone notices
- (b) Delete the sent message and say nothing
- (c) Report it right away to the privacy contact, even if you are unsure how serious it is
- (d) Ask a colleague to quietly fix it

Answer: (c). *Prompt reporting lets the organization limit the harm. Steps such as asking the recipient to delete the file should follow the organization's instructions.*

Question 6 (Objective 1). A spreadsheet with participants' home addresses is emailed to the wrong person. Which is the most important reason this matters?

- (a) It might create paperwork for the organization
- (b) Someone could use the addresses to contact or locate people who never agreed to it
- (c) The organization might be embarrassed
- (d) The file may be too large to store

Answer: (b). *The main harm is to the people whose information was exposed, such as unwanted contact or risks to their safety. Organizational consequences follow from that harm.*

Question 7 (Objectives 2 and 3, short answer). Name one piece of personal data you handle in your role and one habit you will use to protect it.

Sample answers:

"Learner email addresses; I will share them only through the approved drive."

"Student health notes; I will share them only with staff who need them."

"Customer birthdates; I will mask them in screenshots."

Evaluating the Session

Assessment alignment

Each learning objective is checked in two ways, so you can see at a glance that nothing is taught without being practiced and assessed.

Objective	Knowledge check	Spot the Risk activity
1. Explain why data privacy matters	Questions 4 and 6	Discussion prompt "Who could be harmed, and how?" on every card
2. Identify personal and sensitive information	Questions 1 and 7	Cards 2, 3, and 4 (spotting sensitive data)
3. Apply data handling procedures, including when sharing is appropriate	Questions 2, 3, and 7	Cards 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5
4. Recognize and report a potential incident	Question 5	Card 6 (and Card 3 if the post is a breach)

Measuring whether the session worked

Use these simple measures to find out whether the training worked and what to improve. Adjust them to what your organization already tracks.

What to measure	How	When
Reaction: Did participants find it clear and useful?	Three-question exit survey (below).	End of session, or sent right afterward so it does not use session time.
Learning: Can participants apply the concepts?	Knowledge check results and the Spot the Risk debrief. Note which questions or cards groups struggled with.	During the session.
Behavior: Are people using the habits at work?	Short follow-up check with participants or their managers: Have you used the three questions? Can you name the privacy contact? Optionally, review how many incidents and near misses were reported.	About 30 days later.
Improvement: What should change?	Review the results, update scenarios and the customization table, and note common questions to add to the Anticipated Questions section.	After each delivery.

Note: If reports of incidents or near misses go up after the training, that is usually a good sign. It means people recognize problems and feel safe reporting them.

Sample exit survey

Ask participants to rate the first two statements from 1 (strongly disagree) to 5 (strongly agree), then answer the third in their own words.

1. I can explain when it is appropriate to share personal information at work.
2. I know who to contact and what to do if something goes wrong.
3. What is one thing that would make this session more useful?

Sample 30-day follow-up check

Send these questions by email about 30 days after the session, to participants or to their managers. Use the answers to update the scenarios, the customization table, and the Anticipated Questions section.

1. In the past month, have you used the three questions (need, minimum, channel) before sharing personal information? Please give an example.
2. Can you name your privacy contact and say how and how soon to report an incident?
3. Has any situation come up that the training did not prepare you for?

Anticipated Questions

Use these two tables to prepare. The first covers questions participants are likely to ask during the session. The second covers questions you may have as a facilitator while preparing or delivering it. Questions are numbered (P1 to P7 for participants, F1 to F9 for facilitators) so you can refer back to them. Rehearse the answers aloud, and add your organization's specific answers in the customization table.

A. Questions from participants

#	Participant question	Suggested response
P1	Isn't it fine to share this if we all work for the same organization?	Working for the same organization is not enough on its own. Sharing is appropriate when the person needs the information for their role. Use the three questions: need, minimum, channel.
P2	What if my manager tells me to share something I think I should not?	Ask what the information is needed for, and offer to share only the part that is needed. If you are still unsure, check with the privacy contact. Asking is not insubordination.
P3	Can I use my personal phone or email for work if my organization has not given me a company device, or the approved system is slow?	Only if your organization's policy allows it. Many organizations do not issue phones, so check the policy or ask the privacy contact before using a personal device or account. Where it is allowed, use approved apps and accounts only, keep a screen lock on, and do not save personal data on the device. Never use personal messaging apps for personal data. If the approved system is slow, report it so it can be fixed.
P4	Does this apply to more than recorded information, including things I just know from my work?	Yes. Personal information is protected whether it is written down, stored in a system, or only in your head. Do not discuss identifiable people in hallways, group chats, or on social media.

#	Participant question	Suggested response
P5	What happens if I report an incident and it turns out to be nothing?	Nothing negative. Reporting in good faith is always the right call. Many serious incidents were made worse by delay, which is why early reporting matters.
P6	How is this different from the law in my country?	This session covers good practice that applies in most places. Laws differ, and your organization's policy and local law take priority. The privacy contact can explain what applies to your role.
P7	Can I keep a copy of the participant list for my own records?	Only if your role requires it and the retention rule allows it. Otherwise use the approved system as the single source, and delete any working copies when finished.

B. Questions from facilitators, answered by the guide's author

#	Facilitator question	Answer
F1	Do I need to be a privacy or legal expert to deliver this?	No. The session teaches practical habits and a decision test. Before delivering, complete the customization table with your organization's real rules. If a question goes beyond the guide, say so and refer it to the privacy contact after the session.
F2	What if my organization has no formal privacy policy or privacy contact?	Do not choose someone yourself. Find out who is officially responsible by asking HR, your manager, or the IT or compliance team, and confirm their name and contact details before the session. If no one holds the role, ask your manager or HR to assign one, and wait for that decision. Do not deliver the training until you can tell participants exactly who to report to, because the reporting steps have nowhere to go without a named contact.

#	Facilitator question	Answer
F3	Can I shorten or lengthen the session?	Yes, but first check what success requires (see F6 and F9). If a certificate or passing score is required: • Protect the knowledge check and the core content in Section 3. • Cut time from the discussion and activity sections instead. Example 30-minute version with a quiz: • Section 1: 2 minutes • Section 2: 5 minutes • Section 3: 12 minutes • Section 4: 6 minutes, using Cards 1, 4, and 6 only • Section 5: 5 minutes If no quiz or passing score is required: • Assign the knowledge check as a follow-up and give the time to Section 4. 60-minute version: • Use all six cards, add your own examples, and take open questions at the end.
F4	Can I swap in my own scenarios?	Yes, and it is encouraged. Keep one scenario where sharing is appropriate, one where it is not, and one incident. Use fictional or anonymized details only.
F5	What if a participant describes a real incident during the session?	Pause kindly, thank them for raising it, and take it offline right away to the privacy contact. Do not discuss identifying details with the group.
F6	Is the knowledge check graded? Should I record scores?	It depends on your organization. By default it is a learning check: review answers together and record nothing. If your organization issues a certificate or needs proof of completion, confirm in advance how success is determined (attending the full session, finishing the activity, or passing the knowledge check), what the passing score is, whether retakes are allowed, and where records are kept. Tell participants the rules at the start of the session.
F7	My group includes people from several countries or organizations. What changes?	Keep the guide's principles, and tell participants that local law and each organization's policy may differ. Ask groups to apply their own organization's rules in Section 4.
F8	Can I use this for students or minors as the audience?	The structure works, but simplify the language and use age-appropriate scenarios. Check your organization's policy on training minors.

#	Facilitator question	Answer
F9	Does completing this guide give participants a certificate or meet a compliance requirement?	Not by itself. This guide is general training and does not certify anyone or satisfy any legal or contractual requirement. Whether a certificate is issued, and what counts as success (attendance only or passing the knowledge check), is decided by your organization. Confirm this before the session, and follow your organization's compliance process.

Materials Needed

Materials checklist

- Slides or flip chart covering the objectives, key points, five habits, the sharing decision test, and the four incident steps (plain-language version available on request)
- Completed Customization Table (in Before You Facilitate), with your organization's contacts and rules
- One printed set of the six scenario cards per group, plus the facilitator answer key
- Knowledge check copies or a screen-sharing version with the answer key for you
- Participant quick reference handout (last page), one per person
- Sign-in sheet that collects only names, as a model of collecting the minimum
- Exit survey (paper or online) with the three sample questions
- Timer, pens, and flip chart or whiteboard

In person and virtual delivery

- **In person:** Seat participants in small groups from the start so the Section 4 activity begins quickly.
- **Virtual:** Use breakout rooms for Section 2 and Section 4, share the scenario cards in the chat or on screen, and use a poll or the chat for quiz answers.

Accessibility notes

- Materials are available in plain-language and translated formats on request.
- For virtual delivery, enable live captions and share the slides or handout in advance so participants can follow in their own language.
- Read scenario cards aloud for the whole room, allow extra time on request, and offer a digital option so no one has to write by hand.

Troubleshooting common situations

If this happens	Try this
A participant starts describing a real case with identifying details.	Pause kindly, remind the group of the ground rule, and invite them to restate it as a fictional example.
Someone says "we share this all the time."	Apply the sharing decision test together. Frequent practice is not the same as an approved purpose.
Participants feel the rules are too strict.	Acknowledge that sharing is a normal part of work, and show that the test is about purpose, minimum, and channel, not about saying no.
Discussion is quiet, especially online.	Use pair discussions, the chat, or breakout rooms, and call on groups rather than individuals.
You are running behind.	Shorten the Section 2 discussion and move question 7 of the knowledge check to a follow-up.

Participant Handout: Quick Reference

Before you share personal information, ask three questions

1. **Need:** Does this person need it to do their role?
2. **Minimum:** Am I sharing only what they need?
3. **Channel:** Am I using an approved way to share it?

What counts as personal and sensitive data

- **Personal:** name, contact details, photos, ID or account numbers, grades or performance records, location.
- **Sensitive (extra care):** health status, disability or accommodation needs, protection or safeguarding cases, biometric data, financial details.

Five habits

- Collect only what you need.
- Share on a need-to-know basis.
- Use approved channels.
- Protect it where it lives: lock screens, secure files, keep paper out of sight.
- Keep it only as long as needed, then dispose of it securely.

If something goes wrong

1. **Stop.** Do not forward, delete, or fix it quietly.
2. **Report immediately** to the privacy contact below, even if you are unsure it is serious.
3. **Share the facts:** what, when, whose information, and who may have it.
4. **Follow instructions.** The goal is protecting people, not blaming anyone.

Privacy contact

Name: _____

Email: _____

Phone number: _____

How to report it (phone, email, or form): _____

How soon to report (for example, immediately or within 24 hours): _____

My commitment this week: _____

For example: lock my screen whenever I step away; send only the information someone needs; report a mistake the same day. Ask your facilitator for more examples.

iBOS Community Newsletter

Copywriting and Content Excerpts, 2023 to 2024

I served as Personal Assistant & Assistant Manager at International British Online School (iBOS), where I was also the newsletter editor and copywriter. The newsletter was produced about six times a year (twice per trimester), mainly for parents, and was also sent to students and staff worldwide. I handled each issue from start to finish: sourcing and researching content from students, parents, teachers, and administrators; writing text and captions; selecting photos and imagery; compiling the layout; and routing each issue for approval by the Principal and CEO. I also created new interactive features such as the crossword shown here. Excerpts are screenshots of the newsletter as published, cropped to remove student and staff photos and names for privacy. Each caption notes authorship and issue date.

Staff Spotlight (Author's Own Feature)

Purpose: Introduces staff to the community and builds a personal connection between families and the people who teach and support their children.

iBOS Staff Perspective

Katie Taylor, PA to the Principal



I like to think of iBOS as a dynamic cross-cultural education collaboration, standing out for its dedication to building a global educational community. Working alongside colleagues and students from diverse backgrounds creates a vibrant and enriching atmosphere.

Transitioning into an administrative/personal assistant role at iBOS has been a rewarding shift, where my background in international studies and education seamlessly integrates with the school's commitment to holistic learning. Each day is a unique exploration of diverse perspectives and approaches to education.

The global blend of cultures, coupled with a shared commitment to excellence, makes every day at iBOS an inspiring adventure in education.

iBOS Staff Perspective: written by me, about myself, published December 2023.

Interactive Content Created

Purpose: Gives families and students a practical or playful way to engage with the school, through back-to-school tips and a crossword that reinforces facts about iBOS.

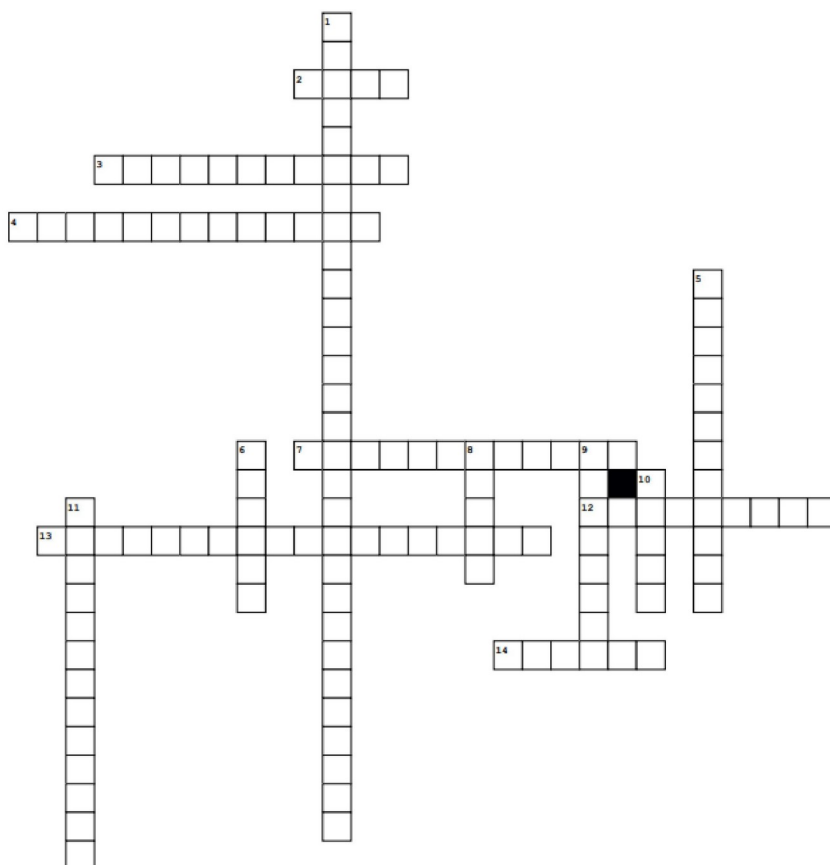
Tips to Return to School:

- Set a Routine to match school hours
- Organise and check your school supplies
- Read books regularly
- Set personal and academic goals
- Engage in regular exercise
- Catch up with family and friends
- Review key concepts from the previous year
- Check the school calendar and prepare to return to school.



Tips to Return to School: drafted by me before I left iBOS; published July 2024, after my departure.

Can you answer all the questions about iBOS to finish the crossword puzzle?



Across

2. The month we finish the academic year 2024.
3. A subject offered at iBOS that involves calculations and equations.
4. A country known for its technology and innovation, is where iBOS is headquartered.
7. The number one priority for all employees at iBOS (12 letters).
12. The number of Sixth Form students currently enrolled (Years 12 and 13)
13. Who is the founding Principal of iBOS?
14. How often students receive reports from individual classes.

Down

1. The international accreditation body we are waiting for final approval from.
5. Form Tutor Time/Assemblies start at this time.
6. The platform where families can find student timetables, attendance information, and reports etc.
8. Chair of Student Council
9. Where students view class materials and work.
10. Where students join online lessons.
11. Who is the Teacher Governor of iBOS?

iBOS Trivia crossword: created by me, published January 2024.

Announcement and Programme Copy

Purpose: Communicates accreditation news and event recaps clearly to build families' confidence in the school.

CIS Accreditation

In February 2024, we became the only online school accredited by the Council of International Schools (CIS). This is a testament to the innovative teaching, learning, and well-being that iBOS provides. Find out more about CIS here: [What does it Mean to be a CIS Accredited School?](#)



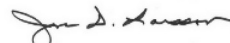
The International British Online School
United Kingdom



Has achieved **International Accreditation**, a mark of recognition held exclusively by schools around the world that exemplify high quality standards in international education.

Conferred by the CIS Board of Trustees

Accredited February 2024


Jane Larsson
Executive Director



Shaping the future of international education

CIS Accreditation announcement: written by me, published April 2024.

DfE Accreditation Visit



In March 2024 we welcomed accreditors from the Office for Standards in Education, Children's Services and Skills (Ofsted) for the final step of our Department for Education (DfE) accreditation process. They observed lessons and had meetings with various members across our iBOS community. Overall it was a positive experience and we are awaiting their final approval for accreditation.

DfE Accreditation Visit announcement: written by me, published April 2024.

Education 2.0 Conference

This three-day, knowledge-intensive, conference was held in Dubai in February 2024. It attracted the most dynamic leaders in the education sector and brought fresh insights and perspectives to empower, inspire, and enrich the global learning community.

Education 2.0 Conference recap: written by me, published April 2024. Photos of the individual pictured have been cropped out.

Seasonal and Community Messaging

Purpose: Thanks families for their support and keeps the relationship warm during term breaks.

Spring Term Break Well Wishes

During the term break, we reflect on the accomplishments of Term 2, marked by dedication, perseverance, and growth. To all students, teachers, and staff, we extend warm well wishes for a rejuvenating pause from our academic pursuits. May this break offer relaxation and reflection, while also serving as a time for focused study and preparation for the exams ahead. Students, take this opportunity to recharge and review your lessons, knowing your efforts are commendable. Teachers, your guidance has been invaluable; use this break to replenish your energy. Staff, thank you for your tireless efforts. Let's carry forward the lessons learned and memories shared as we look ahead to the promise of our continued educational journey together. Wishing you all a restful and rejuvenating term break.

Spring Term Break Well Wishes: written by me, published April 2024.



International British Online School

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Half Term Break Wishes from Admin Team

We would like to take this opportunity to extend our gratitude for your continued support and partnership in your child's education journey at iBOS. We hope that you and your family enjoy a restful and enjoyable half-term break. Thank you once again for your ongoing support, and we eagerly anticipate the return of all our students for another successful term ahead.

Half Term Break Wishes: written by me on behalf of the Admin Team, published January 2024.

Structured Informational Writing

Purpose: Gives families upcoming dates, reminders, and ways to get involved at a glance.

Upcoming Events

- Half-Term Break: 10th February 2023 - 18th February 2024
- Spring Term 2.2 Starts: Monday 19th February 2024 for all students
- Ofsted Visit: Expected 2024 (Generally, Ofsted will call after 1:00 pm and they will be on campus the next day.)
- Parents' Evenings:
 - KS3 Parents' Evening: 21st February 2024
 - KS4 Parents' Evening: 14th March 2024
 - KS5 Parents' Evening: 21st March 2024
- Coffee Events:
 - 1st March
 - 19th March
 - Throughout the Year (Check your Engage Portal Calendar)
- Open Events (For Prospective Families):
 - KS5 (Sixth-Form): 21st February 2024
 - Primary & Secondary: TBD March 2024
- Engage Workshop: TBD
- Term 2.2 Ends: Thursday 28th March 2024

Reminders

- 2023-2024 Parents' Survey: Please submit if you haven't already (link sent via email previously)
- Referral Scheme: Please contact our Admissions Team if you would like to refer students to iBOS and receive a discount on tuition fees for the upcoming academic year
- **Turkey Trip: Please contact Admin if you are interested as we are looking for more students to join!**

iBOS Engagement

We invite you to share your creativity with us! Send photos, videos, student work, etc. for our newsletters, assemblies, and social media to admin@ibos.education. We are excited to see your submissions! Students will receive 5 house points per submission. Also let us know what other incentives would get you participating!



/ ibos.school



/ ibos_school



www.ibos.school

Upcoming Events, Reminders, and iBOS Engagement: written and updated by me each issue, published January 2024.

iBOS Instagram Community Content

Social Media Copywriting, 2023 to 2024

As Personal Assistant & Assistant Manager at International British Online School (iBOS), I wrote the captions for the school's Instagram posts, pairing seasonal and awareness-day graphics with original copy for the school community. A selection is shown below, as published.





World Teacher's Day



ibos.school



♡ 10 💬 2 ↻ 📌



ibos.school 📖 ✨ Happy World Teacher's Day to the heart and soul of our education family at the International British Online School! 🌍 🍎 Today, we celebrate the dedication, passion, and tireless efforts of our educators who shape the future of tomorrow's leaders. Thank you for your commitment to excellence! 🎉 📚 #WorldTeachersDay #IBOSTeachers #EducationHeroes

October 5, 2023